

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1164

By Gant

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Henry Wetter Morgan of Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Henry Wetter Morgan of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Henry Morgan was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Memphis on October 25, 1943, Mr. Morgan was the son of Elise Wetter Morgan and Allen Benners Morgan; he was raised in Memphis and attended Pentecost Garrison, Presbyterian Day School, and Episcopal High School and graduated from Memphis University School; and

WHEREAS, Henry Morgan achieved the rank of Eagle Scout at the early age of thirteen and excelled in tennis and racquetball, winning many trophies; nothing pleased him more than consistently beating his older brother in tennis; and

WHEREAS, following high school, he attended the University of North Carolina, where he served as president of the Delta Kappa Epsilon Fraternity, majored in economics, and graduated in 1965; the friendships he formed during these years continued throughout his life; and

WHEREAS, after college, Henry Morgan joined the Air National Guard, serving as a medic and, simultaneously, began his career at Boyle Investment Company in the insurance department before shifting to the mortgage banking department; and

WHEREAS, in the mid-1970s, Mr. Morgan took over and ran the real estate company's investment property division, leading the development of office, retail, and multifamily

properties; in this role, he was directly involved with or oversaw the development of more than twenty million square feet of commercial space in the Memphis and Nashville markets; and

WHEREAS, a remarkable leader with visionary insight, Henry Morgan guided the company's growth while serving as president from 1985 to 2012 and later as co-chair emeritus alongside his brother-in-law, John Bayard Boyle, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, he often said what he valued most were the people he worked with, and he gave credit to them for the company's success; and

WHEREAS, in 2001, Mr. Morgan was inducted into the Society of Entrepreneurs, and in 2012, he was inducted into the Memphis Area Association of Realtors Commercial Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his community, Henry Morgan served on numerous boards including the board of directors for the Memphis Area Chamber of Commerce and the board of the Baptist Memorial Healthcare Foundation as a member and past chairman; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Morgan was a board member of the Memphis Arts Council, Memphis University School, Grace St. Luke's Episcopal School, Trezevant Manor, and Boys & Girls Clubs of Memphis; he also served as a vestry member of St. John's Episcopal Church; and

WHEREAS, Henry Morgan was an accomplished sportsman and was passionate about conservation, supporting organizations including Ducks Unlimited, Delta Wildlife, the Wild Turkey Federation, the Wolf River Conservancy, The Nature Conservancy, and the TennGreen Land Conservancy; he found his greatest joy being with family and friends in the outdoors, whether in a field, the woods, or fly fishing on a river; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Morgan lived by unwavering values: give your best, do what is right, and treat others with dignity and respect; he had a friendly and welcoming manner, with a smile that could light up the room; and

WHEREAS, others consistently sought his counsel because of his sound judgement and the value he placed on fairness; and

WHEREAS, Henry Morgan will be remembered as a devoted husband, father, grandfather, friend, and a respected business leader, always conducting himself with the highest standards of honor; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his beloved wife, Snowden Boyle Morgan; sons, Henry Wetter (Mena) Morgan, Jr., and Bayard Boyle Morgan (Jane Hart); cherished grandchildren, Elliott Snowden Morgan, Sarah McLean Morgan, Bayard Wyatt Morgan, Gwin Anne Marguerite Morgan, and Henry Kemp Morgan; siblings, Allen Benners (Musette) Morgan, Jr., and Elise Morgan Stratton; and a host of nieces, nephews, and cousins; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Morgan leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Henry Wetter Morgan, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Morgan.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.